

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2022 - Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 46)

5.1 Max 8 – In each region separated by +, award 1 point if correct.

5.2 Max 12 – For each answer: award 3 points if all correct, 2 points if one mistake, 1 point if two mistakes OR one word correct (even with the other having more than 2 mistake).

Q 5.1	(a) <i>Their people + saw the cedars.</i>
	(b) <i>His deer + hit the mother.</i>
	(c) <i>His cedars + hit the people.</i>
	(d) <i>The sparrows + waited for the deers.</i>
Q 5.2	(a) kəmp'jwnemə ipikaxi
	(b) p'ine ipikimɯ
	(c) kiwcine iwp'imɯ
	(d) ipəna p'ɔyxi

5.3 Max 26 – Broken down as follows:

Syntax: 4

Possession marking: 4

Class agreement: 8

Verb agreement: 10

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2022 - Round 2

Commentary

- Nouns are classified by number, animacy and class.
 - Animate nouns are **ka** mother, **pɛ** deer, **p'iw** sparrow, **p'qy** brother, **t'oy** person.
 - Inanimate nouns are **ci** eye, **hɥ** cedar, **ki** blanket, **p'i** head.
 - Class is decided as follows:

	Singular	Plural
Animate	A	B
Inanimate	B	C

- A subject noun is then structured as follows:

POSSESSOR	CLASS PREFIX	STEM	CLASS SUFFIX
None: ∅ 1p: ki 2s: kɔ 3s: ɔ 3p: i	Not possessed: ∅ Class A: ∅ Class B: m Class C: w		Class A: na Class B: nema Class C: ne

- The verb agrees for the number of the subject, and the class of the object.
- The verb is structured as follows.

AGREEMENT PREFIX	OBJECT	STEM
Sg > A: ∅ Sg > B: i (Sg > C: u) Pl > A: i Pl > B: ipi Pl > C: iw		saw: mɥ hit: mɔt'ɛ waited for: xi

- Note that some inanimate nouns take Class A in the singular, or take **-nɔ** for **-nema** but these do not feature in the problem.

Sources:

An Outline of Taos Grammar, George Trager, in Linguistic structures of native America

Taos II: Pronominal Reference, George Trager

Taos IV: Morphemics, Syntax, Semology in Nouns and in Pronominal Reference, George Trager